Sorting Words and Letters

Year 4 · Supplementary Worksheet — extra practice & worked breakdowns

Worked Examples

Example 1 — Alphabetising a single word: Put the letters of 'CANDLE' into alphabetical order.

Answer: List the letters: C, A, N, D, L, E. Sort them: A, C, D, E, L, N. Joined together: ACDELN.

Example 2 — Splitting and sorting two halves: Sort the two halves of this word alphabetically by their first letter, then join them back together with a hyphen: 'GARDEN' split as 'GAR' and 'DEN'.

Answer: Compare the first letters: 'G' (from GAR) and 'D' (from DEN). D comes before G alphabetically, so DEN goes first. Answer: DEN-GAR.

Example 3 — Multiple choice sorting: Which option shows the letters of 'HAMMER' correctly sorted into alphabetical order? A) AEHMMR B) HAMMER C) RMMEHA D) AHEMRM

Answer: Sort H, A, M, M, E, R: A, E, H, M, M, R. That matches option A. Answer: A — AEHMMR.

Example 4 — A longer word: Put the letters of 'TUNNEL' into alphabetical order.

Answer: List the letters: T, U, N, N, E, L. Sort them: E, L, N, N, T, U. Joined together: ELNNTU.

Example 5 — Checking your work: Put the letters of 'ISLAND' into alphabetical order, then check your answer has the same number of letters as the original word.

Answer: List the letters: I, S, L, A, N, D. Sort them: A, D, I, L, N, S. ADILNS has 6 letters, the same as ISLAND (6 letters), so the answer is correct: ADILNS.

Foundation

(15 questions)

1. Put the letters of 'BRIDGE' into alphabetical order.
2. Put the letters of 'CANDLE' into alphabetical order.
3. Put the letters of 'DRAGON' into alphabetical order.

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4. Put the letters of 'FOREST' into alphabetical order.
5. Put the letters of 'GARDEN' into alphabetical order.
6. Put the letters of 'HAMMER' into alphabetical order.
7. Put the letters of 'ISLAND' into alphabetical order.
8. Put the letters of 'JACKET' into alphabetical order.
9. Put the letters of 'KETTLE' into alphabetical order.
10. Put the letters of 'LADDER' into alphabetical order.
11. Put the letters of 'MARBLE' into alphabetical order.
12. Put the letters of 'NEEDLE' into alphabetical order.
13. Put the letters of 'ORANGE' into alphabetical order.
14. Put the letters of 'PENCIL' into alphabetical order.
15. Put the letters of 'RABBIT' into alphabetical order.

Standard

(20 questions)

1. Sort the two halves of this word alphabetically by their first letter, then join them back together with a hyphen: 'BRIDGE' split as 'BRI' and 'DGE'.
2. Sort the two halves of this word alphabetically by their first letter, then join them back together with a hyphen: 'CANDLE' split as 'CAN' and 'DLE'.
3. Sort the two halves of this word alphabetically by their first letter, then join them back together with a hyphen: 'DRAGON' split as 'DRA' and 'GON'.
4. Sort the two halves of this word alphabetically by their first letter, then join them back together with a hyphen: 'FOREST' split as 'FOR' and 'EST'.
5. Sort the two halves of this word alphabetically by their first letter, then join them back together with a hyphen: 'GARDEN' split as 'GAR' and 'DEN'.
6. Sort the two halves of this word alphabetically by their first letter, then join them back together with a hyphen: 'HAMMER' split as 'HAM' and 'MER'.
7. Sort the two halves of this word alphabetically by their first letter, then join them back together with a hyphen: 'ISLAND' split as 'ISL' and 'AND'.
8. Sort the two halves of this word alphabetically by their first letter, then join them back together with a hyphen: 'JACKET' split as 'JAC' and 'KET'.
9. Sort the two halves of this word alphabetically by their first letter, then join them back together with a hyphen: 'KETTLE' split as 'KET' and 'TLE'.
10. Sort the two halves of this word alphabetically by their first letter, then join them back together with a hyphen: 'LADDER' split as 'LAD' and 'DER'.
11. Sort the two halves of this word alphabetically by their first letter, then join them back together with a hyphen: 'MARBLE' split as 'MAR' and 'BLE'.

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12. Sort the two halves of this word alphabetically by their first letter, then join them back together with a hyphen: 'NEEDLE' split as 'NEE' and 'DLE'.

13. Sort the two halves of this word alphabetically by their first letter, then join them back together with a hyphen: 'ORANGE' split as 'ORA' and 'NGE'.

14. Sort the two halves of this word alphabetically by their first letter, then join them back together with a hyphen: 'PENCIL' split as 'PEN' and 'CIL'.

15. Sort the two halves of this word alphabetically by their first letter, then join them back together with a hyphen: 'RABBIT' split as 'RAB' and 'BIT'.

16. Sort the two halves of this word alphabetically by their first letter, then join them back together with a hyphen: 'SADDLE' split as 'SAD' and 'DLE'.

17. Sort the two halves of this word alphabetically by their first letter, then join them back together with a hyphen: 'TUNNEL' split as 'TUN' and 'NEL'.

18. Sort the two halves of this word alphabetically by their first letter, then join them back together with a hyphen: 'VELVET' split as 'VEL' and 'VET'.

19. Sort the two halves of this word alphabetically by their first letter, then join them back together with a hyphen: 'WINDOW' split as 'WIN' and 'DOW'.

20. Sort the two halves of this word alphabetically by their first letter, then join them back together with a hyphen: 'YELLOW' split as 'YEL' and 'LOW'.

Hard

(5 questions)

1. Which option shows the letters of 'SADDLE' correctly sorted into alphabetical order? A) SLEDDA B) SADDLE C) SADDLEZ D) ADDELS

2. Which option shows the letters of 'TUNNEL' correctly sorted into alphabetical order? A) TUNNELZ B) UTNNLE C) TUNNEL D) ELNNTU

3. Which option shows the letters of 'VELVET' correctly sorted into alphabetical order? A) EELTVV B) VVTLEE C) VELVET D) VELVETZ

4. Which option shows the letters of 'WINDOW' correctly sorted into alphabetical order? A) WINDOW B) WWONID C) WINDOWZ D) DINOWW

5. Which option shows the letters of 'YELLOW' correctly sorted into alphabetical order? A) YWOLLE B) YELLOW C) ELLOWY D) YELLOWZ

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